OVERHEAD DESKTOP + CYLINDER 0.3.24 - OCTOBER 2026

Your guide to getting work done.

Choose the right Desktop or Cylinder package, set up your workspace, and use the shared tools for customer work, team handoffs, and safer administration.

1. Open your workspace
Create or sign into your staff account.

2. Add one customer
Use Customers → Add customer.

3. Record one next step
Use Team Dashboard → Add Note.

How to read this guide: bold text names a screen, field, or button. Each chapter starts with where to find it. Labels can differ slightly by package, installed version, role, and plan.

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> This guide covers OverHead Desktop, Cylinder Server, and Cylinder Client. Desktop is the individual-user Windows app. Cylinder Server is the department host; Cylinder Client is its managed Windows workstation endpoint. Roles, Rank, device authorization, plan, and installed version determine which controls appear. The customer support portal is separate.

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Choose Desktop or Cylinder

Where: Before installation

Three packages, two capacities

Package	Use it on	What it is for
OverHead Desktop	Regular Windows 10 or 11	Individual-user office capacity. Core customer, work, accessibility, planning, backup, and update tools run locally. It has no centralized department GPO controls.
Cylinder Server	Supported Windows Server or Windows IoT	Department host for a larger employee group. Adds centralized Cylinder membership, Ranks, department scope, device policy, and Owner controls.
Cylinder Client	Managed Windows 10/11 workstation or remote desktop endpoint	Employee endpoint connected to a Cylinder workspace. It shares the day-to-day OverHead workflows and checks the enrolled device and employee against Cylinder policy. It does not administer the department.

All three packages share the core OverHead renderer and work tools, so common UX and workflow improvements appear in each package. Server and Client have separate installers, data folders, and update feeds. Cylinder policy controls access to OverHead; it does not configure native Windows Group Policy, Active Directory, or Entra.

> Customer records, attachments, and backups remain on the computer where they are stored unless you explicitly use a supported sync or export. Cylinder identity and device policy are centrally checked; local business files do not automatically replicate between Server and Client.

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Install, sign in, and start your workspace

Where: Windows desktop · Sign-in screen

Choose the standard Windows app

1. Choose the correct package from the official OverHead site. Open the downloaded EXE and follow its installation prompts.
2. If you choose the portable ZIP instead, right-click it in File Explorer, select **Extract All**, and keep the extracted files together. Open the app inside that folder. Do not run it from inside the ZIP.
3. Open OverHead from its installed shortcut or extracted folder. Choose Desktop for a regular Windows 10/11 office computer. Cylinder Server is for supported Windows Server or Windows IoT hosts; Cylinder Client is for managed Windows 10/11 workstations and remote desktop endpoints. Use a matching installer and update channel.

Create or open an office workspace

1. For a new office, choose **Create Workspace**. Enter the owner name, business name, email, and a password of at least 12 characters. Read and accept the terms, then select **Create Workspace**.
2. Complete email verification when requested. If the app directs you to your inbox, use the newest verification message and return to OverHead.
3. For an existing staff account, choose **OverHead Team**, enter the account email and password, and select **Open Team Workspace**. Use the same identity on the website and desktop.

> **You are ready when:** the internal workspace opens with **Team Dashboard** and your business name. A screen showing only customer support is the customer portal, not the staff workspace.

About the free trial

The trial offer is one 90-day Gold trial per workspace, with no card or charge. After setup, check **Plans** and **Licenses** for your assigned access. If Gold access or trial status is missing, use the checks in Plans and Payments; do not start a paid checkout just to troubleshoot a free trial.

> Download installers only from the official OverHead site or an approved department distribution share. Check the product name and version before installing. Do not disable Windows protection to install the app.

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Find your way around

Where: Left navigation · Top search · Operations drawer

Choose a section in the left navigation. Scroll within the main workspace to see controls below the first screen. Available actions depend on your role and plan.

Open this section	To do this
Team Dashboard	Review current work; add notes; choose visible dashboard panels; create and update appointments, quotes, and invoices.
Reports	Owners and bookkeepers can filter invoices, quotes, appointments, or tasks by date, export a local CSV, and schedule a one-time local CSV export.
Growth & Work	Owners, front desk, and bookkeepers can customize dashboards, maintain task/project boards, request project status changes for Owner review, and review planned task estimates against manually entered weekly team capacity.
Work Planner	Review task dependencies, team capacity, time capture, role-specific checklists, and shift handoffs. Handoff exports are local files; review them before sharing.
Sales Studio	Owners, front desk, and bookkeepers can forecast opportunities, qualify leads, record deal activity, and manage local sales playbooks.
Customer Management	Owners, front desk, and bookkeepers can manage customer segments, health, structured contacts, consent, ownership rules, and feedback intake. Owners can merge local duplicate records after reviewing an encrypted backup and confirmation; shared cloud records are not merged.
Scheduling	Create local appointments, capacity plans, and time records. Public booking and calendar sync need an external account setup.
Finance	Owners and bookkeepers can track invoices, expenses, budgets, and close checklists.
People	Owners can maintain staff planning, reviews, and role-specific development records.
Documents / Team & Comms	Track document review and retention and maintain local collaboration notes and handoffs.
Field & Assist	Capture offline field notes and checklists, optionally type a site location after confirming permission to record it, record and download an audio note after granting microphone access, and use optional rule-based suggestions with Owner opt-in.
Rule Builder	Owners define reviewable automation rules. Enabling rules may create local work; third-party actions need a configured service.

Open this section	To do this
Integrations	Review connection status, validate CSV imports, and export accounting CSVs. Provider sign-in and sync are separate.
Search and command palette	Search accessible records and open workspaces or actions. Use Ctrl+K (or Command+K on Mac keyboards) to search commands and switch workspaces; arrow keys move through results and Enter opens a choice.
Quick tools	Use Quick create for common records, the Action inbox for open tasks/support/queued work, and Setup for first-run steps.
Customers	Add, find, and select customer records; attach documents.
Workflows	Choose a repeatable work template and create its next action.
Automations	Review queued jobs, run due work, retry failed jobs, and apply customer playbooks.
Tools	Create fillable PDF packets and queue dated reminders.
Accounts	Manage staff profiles and management approvals.
Licenses	Check user license, subscription, and access status.
Plans / Payments	Review plan access / refresh shared billing and manage Stripe test references.
Import / Square	Preview Microsoft records / work with Square setup and reference summaries.
Evidence / Security	Review activity and integrity / privacy and recovery information.
Support	Create a ticket, check the shared support queue, and review policy documents.
Settings	Change appearance and motion preferences, sync customers, back up, restore, and check for updates.

Search, shortcuts, and easier navigation

The top toolbar provides Search all records, Quick create, Action inbox, Setup, Shortcuts & comfort, and Check updates. Press **Ctrl+K** to search commands and switch workspaces; use Up/Down and Enter. Press **Esc** to close a panel. Workspace and tool tabs support arrow-key movement. Owners can configure direct workspace shortcuts in Settings. Collapse the sidebar to give the work area more room.

Use **Shortcuts & comfort** to adjust text size, turn on high contrast, and open backup and recovery tools. Use **Privacy on/off** to mask or reveal sensitive records; use **Lock** when leaving the desk.

Personalize the workspace directory

Use the **Workspace directory** to search sections, filter by a saved collection, reorder visible sections, or hide a section from this list. Open **Personalize navigation and display** to adjust sidebar width, spacing, control size,

compact labels, and descriptions. Collections let you group sections for different routines. Export or import navigation preferences as a JSON file, or reset the layout to its defaults.

> Navigation choices are stored on this device. Hiding a workspace only hides its directory entry; it does not change role access or permissions. Imported preference files change display/navigation settings, not business records.

Open the Workspace helper

Choose **Open helper** in the app shell to see a summary of loaded tasks, customers, and appointments; links to your tasks and record-completeness checks; a fictional workflow preview; and recent activity. Its guidance and privacy area links to policy acknowledgements, external-service permissions, and a review-before-create support-bundle flow. A sample workflow is not saved. Support bundles are written locally only after an authorized user reviews and confirms the contents.

> A label such as “Protected record” usually means privacy mode is masking the screen. A “higher plan” or permission error is different: ask the workspace owner to check your access.

Add a customer and keep their documents together

Where: Customers → Add customer / Customer documents

Add your first record

1. Open **Customers** and scroll to **Add customer**.
2. Enter **Business name**, **Owner name**, **Email**, **Industry**, and **Service area**. Choose **Preferred contact**. Correct any required-field or email error shown by the form.
3. Select **Add Customer**. Wait for the confirmation before submitting again.
4. Use **Find a customer** to find the saved record, then select it in the customer list. Check the **Selected customer** name before working on it.

> **Check your result:** the record appears in the list and the selected details match what you entered. Customer creation can also queue a workflow setup task.

Attach and reopen a document

1. Select the intended customer. In **Customer documents**, add an optional **Document label**.
2. Select **Attach Document** and choose the file. Use a file smaller than 25 MB.
3. Check that the label appears under that customer. Select the document label to open it in its associated Windows program.

Search, annotate, and bundle customer files

1. Open **Documents**. Under **Customer file rooms**, select stored attachments and choose **Download selected files as ZIP**. The native save dialog chooses where the archive goes; the bundle limit is 100 files and 250 MB.
2. Under **Search and activity**, search file contents in TXT, CSV, and DOCX files. Each file is limited to 4 MB, and a search scans at most 200 files and 50 MB total. PDF OCR, spreadsheets, and images are not searched.
3. Under **Versions and approvals**, add a visible text annotation to a PDF page. OverHead saves a new annotated copy and preserves the original; this is not freehand PDF editing.

Invite a customer to their support portal

The workspace owner can select a customer and choose **Create Customer Access Invitation**. Follow the invitation instructions shown by the app. The customer uses the customer-account flow; this does not give them staff access to the office.

> Attached files remain on this device. Customer synchronization does not transfer document files to another computer. Keep the original files or a separate document backup.

If you cannot find the record

Clear the search, confirm you are in the correct workspace, and check privacy mode. For shared records, open **Settings** → **Customer synchronization** → **Sync Now**. Read the result before creating another copy.

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Use the dashboard for your daily work

Where: Team Dashboard → Current work

Add a follow-up or office note

1. Open **Team Dashboard** and find **Current work**.
2. In **Quick note or office reminder**, write one specific action: “Call Taylor about the pending quote.”
3. Select **Add Note**. Check for the saved confirmation and look for the action in the queue.

Choose the dashboard panels you need

Select **Customize dashboard** to show or hide panels. Choose **Show all** to restore the full dashboard. At least one panel stays visible. Your choice is saved on this device.

Find and finish work

1. Choose **Open**, **Queued**, **Blocked**, **Complete**, or **All**. Use **Search current work** to narrow the list.
2. Review the action, area, and status. If the text is protected, reveal it only when the screen is private.
3. After actually completing the action, select **Done**. Open the **Complete** filter to confirm its status.

> A task marked Complete is an office record of completion. It does not prove an email was delivered, a customer accepted a quote, or a card was charged. Confirm the real-world action separately.

Use Work quality and data checks

On **Team Dashboard**, scroll past the dashboard panels to **Work quality and data checks**. These cards summarize available local data; they do not change records unless you choose an action.

Card	What it does
My work today	Shows open tasks due today assigned to you (or unassigned tasks) and appointments scheduled today.
Possible duplicate customers	Flags exact matching emails, or exact names when email is missing. Review the records before using the existing customer merge flow.
Bulk task status	Select local tasks, review each current and new status, then confirm or cancel the change.
CSV row check	Checks headers, row width, repeated rows, and columns you mark required. This preview does not import the file.

Card	What it does
Appointment conflicts	Lists overlapping appointments. If duration is missing it assumes 60 minutes; assigned appointments are compared by assignee.
Customer data completeness	Lists loaded customer records missing a name, email, phone, or service area. It never fills fields automatically.
Local backup status	Shows backup inventory returned by the local backup service. Owners and Bookkeepers can create a backup from this card; the backup remains local.
Operations export history	Creates a local CSV of current tasks, appointments, and customers, then keeps a device-local list of exports from this card. The list is not a complete history of every export in OverHead.
Existing draft recovery	Explains that supported forms save drafts on this device; reopen the form to resume.

> The cards use the records currently available to this signed-in workspace. Counts and findings are review aids, not proof that records are complete, unique, backed up, or synchronized across devices. Check the relevant workspace before acting.

Run a simple Revenue Leak Check

Use these existing screens as a daily review routine:

- **Quotes:** check Draft and Sent quotes under **Update and deliver work**; add a follow-up note for those waiting on a response.
- **Invoices:** check Open and Sent invoices and their due dates.
- **Unassigned records:** select the correct Customer for quotes, invoices, or appointments that need one.
- **Approvals:** review pending requests in **Accounts**.
- **Next action:** leave a clear note or reminder for each item that needs attention.

> **End-of-day check:** tomorrow’s most important follow-up is recorded, completed work is marked, and unresolved items still have a visible next step.

Create appointments, quotes, and invoices

Where: Team Dashboard → Create office work → Update and deliver work

Create the record

1. On **Team Dashboard**, scroll to **Create office work**. Choose **appointment**, **quote**, or **invoice**.
2. Enter a descriptive **Title** and choose the **Customer**. Add the customer in Customers first if it is not listed.
3. For an appointment, enter **Scheduled for**. For a quote or invoice, enter **Amount**; an invoice also has a **Due date**. Add useful internal **Notes**.
4. Select **Create appointment**, **Create quote**, or **Create invoice**. Check the confirmation and the saved record list.

Update status or customer assignment

Scroll to **Update and deliver work**, choose the record type, and find the saved row. Change its **Status** or **Customer** selection. The change is saved by the selection; watch for a confirmation or error.

Record	Available statuses
Appointment	Scheduled · Confirmed · Complete · Canceled
Quote	Draft · Sent · Accepted · Declined
Invoice	Open · Sent · Paid · Void

Create a customer-facing PDF

1. In the quote or invoice row, select **Create PDF**.
2. Note the generated file path in the confirmation. Open that location in File Explorer and review the PDF.
3. Confirm the customer, amount, dates, and wording before sharing it through your normal email or delivery process.

> Creating a PDF does not send it. Selecting Sent or Paid records a status; it does not send a message or collect a payment. Mark Paid only after confirming payment through your actual payment records.

> **Check your result:** the record is assigned to the correct customer and the generated PDF agrees with the saved information.

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Use workflows, reminders, and automations

Where: Workflows · Tools → Reminder launcher · Automations

Start a workflow

1. Open **Workflows**. Select **Scheduling**, **Customer Answers**, **Quotes**, **Invoices**, or **Follow-up**.
2. Read the template guidance, then select **Create work**.
3. Open **Automations** to inspect the queued workflow job. Creating workflow work is different from creating an actual quote or invoice; use Team Dashboard for those records.

Queue a dated reminder

1. Open **Tools → Reminder launcher**. Enter the action in **Reminder**.
2. Choose a date and time under **Run at**. Leave it blank, or choose **Run today**, to make it due now.
3. Select **Queue Reminder**, then check the job under Automations.

Review and process jobs

In **Automations**, filter by **Queued**, **Complete**, **Dead Letter**, or **All**. Use **Search automations** to find a job. **Run Due** processes jobs whose time has arrived. **Queue Digest** adds an owner-summary job.

“Dead Letter” means a job needs attention after unsuccessful processing. Read its error, correct the cause, and then select **Retry Job**. Repeated retries without fixing the cause are unlikely to help.

Exchange calendar files

In Scheduling, import a standard .ics file or export the local calendar file. This is a manual file exchange; provider account sync is not included.

Schedule local reports

In Reports, choose the report filters and a future local delivery time. The desktop scheduler saves a CSV and an in-app notice while OverHead is open and the creating Owner or Bookkeeper is signed in. It does not send email or upload the report.

Set a customer playbook

Under **Customer operating playbook**, choose a Customer and select **Intake Control**, **Quote Approval**, or **Payment Follow-up**. Select **Apply Playbook**, then check the customer’s displayed Operating playbook. **Build First-Day Plan** is another starting point for setup guidance.

Owners can also save exact-match field-update rules in Rule Builder. Select a local feature collection, match field/value, and target field/value, then choose **Evaluate current records**. Each run updates up to 100 matching records; system ID and timestamp fields are protected.

> Desktop jobs need the app running and an active session. External delivery also depends on its configured provider. A queued or completed internal job is not a delivery receipt.

Manage staff access and approvals

Where: Accounts · Licenses

Use an owner account for staff administration. Other roles may see fewer controls or receive a permission message.

Create a staff profile

1. Open **Accounts → Invite staff with a defined role**.
2. Enter **Name**, **Email**, and a **Temporary password** of at least 12 characters. Choose Front Desk, Bookkeeper, or Support.
3. Select **Create Staff Account**. Follow the result shown by the app and share access instructions privately.
4. Confirm the person can open the intended workspace. Do not assume that creating a local staff profile also completed a shared website invitation.

Change a profile

1. Select the person’s profile in Accounts. Check the email before changing anything.
2. Review Name, Business, Role, and Status. Use **Suspended** to restrict a profile that should not be active.
3. Select **Save Account** and confirm the saved result. For shared accounts, verify the result on the website too.

Request and review approval

1. Find **Management approvals**. Choose the action type, such as Quote send, Data export, or Staff access.
2. Enter a clear **Title** and **Details**, then enter an optional request amount, and select **Request Approval**.
3. The authorized reviewer reads the request and selects **Approve** or **Reject**. Check the resulting status.

> An approval records a decision. Confirm whether the underlying action still needs to be performed; do not assume approving a quote request automatically emails the quote.

Owners can configure action and amount routes in Management approvals. The backend assigns eligible reviewers, sends requests without a matching reviewer or above the configured threshold to the Owner, and enforces the assigned reviewer for the final decision.

Set local record ID sequences

Owners can set validated prefixes and starting numbers for supported new customer, task, quote, invoice, expense, appointment, and document IDs in Settings. Existing records are not renumbered; an unset sequence keeps the current default format.

Check licenses

Open **Licenses** to inspect subscription, license number, and access status. Website role names can differ from desktop labels: a workspace administrator may appear as Owner in the desktop. Customer portal access is separate from staff access.

> **Check your result:** the right person can open the right workspace and has only the role needed for their work.

Manage a Cylinder department

Where: Cylinder Management and Plans

How Cylinder Ranks work

Rank	Who it is for	Typical authority
1 - Regular User	Starting rank for employees	Use assigned business work and approved devices.
2 - Management	Department managers	Manage assigned people/departments and delegated operations within Rank limits.
3 - Administrator	Workspace administrators	Manage broader department access, devices, and policy subject to Owner authority.
4 - Owner	Workspace owner	Controls workspace membership, high-level policy, device access, and recovery.

Rank controls Cylinder administration. Job function (such as Support, Front Desk, or Bookkeeper) controls which business workspaces and records an employee uses. Assign only the access needed for the person's job. Lower Ranks cannot raise their own authority or change a higher-Rank member.

Add or update an employee

1. On the Cylinder Server, open **Cylinder Management** and review the signed-in Rank and workspace.
2. Choose **Invite employee**. Enter the employee identity, starting Rank, job function, and at least one department.
3. Share the one-time setup link privately. The employee completes password setup and email verification before the membership activates.
4. For an existing employee, change only the needed Rank, job function, department, or status and save. Suspend or remove access when it is no longer needed.

Approve devices and set access policy

Review new device enrollments before granting access. Approve or block the specific device from the management view. The Owner can set a minimum app version, an offline grace period, or pause employee access. Online policy is checked at sign-in and periodically while the app is open; offline grace determines how long a disconnected endpoint can continue protected work after a central change. Keep an Owner recovery path available.

Deploy Cylinder Client

The optional workstation package can be staged from the Server installer. Distribute it through the supplied package/deployment script, a VPN-accessible share, or your existing software management system. Install only on supported Windows 10/11 endpoints. Remote installation requires reachable devices and configured, authorized PowerShell remoting. The Client uses the department's Cylinder policy, but management actions remain on the Server and restricted by Rank.

> These are OverHead Cylinder access controls. They do not create or change native Windows GPO, Active Directory, Entra, VPN, or endpoint-management configuration. Confirm Windows and network policy with your IT administrator.

Understand the trial, plan access, and Payments

Where: Plans · Licenses · Payments

Check your assigned plan

1. Open **Plans**. Read the **Active** plan and the Open/Locked feature labels. Selecting a plan card alone does not prove your access changed.
2. Open **Licenses** to check your profile's status.
3. If you use a shared account, open **Payments** and select **Sync Shared Plan and License**. Read Shared billing status and Last successful sync.

Your 90-day trial

The offer is a single, no-card 90-day Gold trial per workspace. Verify the assigned access shown in the app. If your account does not show the expected trial, contact support with the workspace email, installed version, and exact status. Do not enter a card or choose a paid subscription merely to make trial access appear.

Shared records and refresh

The website and signed-in OverHead clients use the same Firebase account and workspace entitlement/license records. The website reads them live. Desktop refreshes during sign-in and every five minutes during an active staff session; the app also keeps a local offline cache. Cylinder shares identity/profile data and applies its separate Rank and device policies.

What the Payments controls do

The current production website billing view is read-only. Paid checkout, paid plan changes, seat charges, Stripe portal access, and subscription cancellation are not available because the production `billingApi` is not deployed. The live no-card 90-day Gold trial is a separate service. Test-reference controls do not collect money or grant paid access.

- **Sync Shared Plan and License:** reads the shared plan/license records used by the website.
- **Open Stripe Test Dashboard:** opens Stripe in your browser. It does not itself connect a merchant account.
- **Save Test Details / Test Reference:** saves non-secret test references. It is not confirmation of Stripe authorization.

Common sync messages

Shared sign-in required: use your shared account. **Sign-in expired:** sign out and back in. **No shared billing record:** ask support to check the workspace's access. **Needs attention:** read the accompanying error and retry after correcting it.

Never enter a Stripe secret key or webhook secret in the desktop app. For subscription cancellation or refunds, confirm availability with support; a manual reference entry is not a cancellation request.

Bring in existing records

Where: Import · Square

Microsoft contacts and Business Central customers

This is optional. Your Microsoft administrator may need to supply the approved application/client ID and tenant details before you can connect.

1. Open **Import**. Choose Microsoft 365 contacts (Outlook) or Dynamics 365 Business Central customers under **Source**.
2. Enter the approved application and tenant details; Business Central also asks for its environment.
3. Select **Connect With Microsoft**. Sign in on Microsoft's browser page. If asked for a device code, use the one displayed by OverHead.
4. Select the relevant **Preview** button. For Business Central, choose the Company and select **Preview Company Customers**.
5. Check the records you want and select **Import Selected Records**. Review the imported and skipped counts.
6. Open **Customers** and inspect the new entries before relying on them.

> **Check your result:** the selected customer records appear with the expected names and contact details. Previewing alone does not import them.

> The preview reads up to 50 records and can expire. If it expires, preview again. Duplicate records are checked at import time; a zero selection imports nothing. This flow creates local customer records and does not edit the Microsoft source.

Square setup and summaries

Square has its own provider setup and summary-import screen. Treat manually entered customer, catalog, order, or payment counts as reference summaries. Opening a browser page or saving a summary does not establish an automatic live transaction feed.

Keep the first setup simple

You can add customers manually and use the main work screens without completing an optional integration. If connection details are unfamiliar, ask the workspace owner or support before changing them. Enter your Microsoft password only on Microsoft's sign-in page.

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Know where your records and PDFs go

Where: Customers · Tools · Settings → Customer synchronization

Information	What to expect
Shared customer records	Can synchronize for a signed-in workspace account. Check the displayed sync result.
Customer documents	Attached files stay on the device. Customer sync does not copy them.
Generated PDFs and exports	Saved locally at the file path shown after creation.
Plans and member licenses	Shared records can be refreshed from Payments.

Synchronize customer records

1. Open **Settings** → **Customer synchronization**.
2. Select **Sync Now**. Read the Status, message, and last-sync time.
3. Open Customers and check the expected record. On another device, sign into the same workspace and sync there too.

When enabled, automatic customer sync runs after shared sign-in/local customer creation and every five minutes. A local account or customer-portal account is not a shared staff sync session. Do not assume every local task or attachment has synchronized merely because customer sync succeeded.

Create a fillable packet

1. Open **Tools** → **Fillable PDF packet**.
2. Choose Customer intake, Quote review, or Support request under **Packet type**.
3. Select **Create Fillable PDF**. Open the resulting path in File Explorer and inspect the document.

> In this build the generic Tools packet uses the first customer record when one is present. Review the customer details carefully. For a PDF tied to a particular saved quote or invoice, use that record's **Create PDF** button on Team Dashboard.

Find an output file

Copy the folder portion of the path in the confirmation into File Explorer's address bar. Settings shows the local store location under Local workspace health. If a PDF will not open, use a PDF reader; if an attached document will not open, check its file association in Windows.

Back up, export, and restore safely

Where: Settings → Local workspace health / Restore workspace

Create a backup

1. Sign in as an authorized owner or bookkeeper. Open **Settings** → **Local workspace health**.
2. Select **Create Backup**. Wait for the saved confirmation and note the backup path.
3. Find the file in File Explorer and keep a protected copy outside the computer when practical.

> A local database backup is not a complete copy of every attachment and generated file. Preserve the document files you need separately. A second copy on the same drive will not protect against failure of that drive.

Export or collect support information

Data Export creates an export for review or transfer. **Support Bundle** collects diagnostic material. Both buttons are in Settings. Read the output path and review the files before sharing them; exports and support bundles may contain business information.

Restore only when you intend to replace local data

1. Make a fresh backup of the current workspace first. Keep original documents and files that need separate protection.
2. Under **Restore workspace**, enter the path to the intended **.secure** or **.json** store file.
3. Select **Validate Restore**. Stop if validation fails. Do not rename a random file to make it appear to be a backup.
4. After confirming the target, type **RESTORE** in the confirmation field and select **Restore Local Workspace**.
5. The restore replaces the local workspace, makes a safety backup, and signs you out. Sign in again and check several expected records.

> **Check your result:** the expected customers and work records are present. Recheck shared synchronization and attached documents separately.

If you do not recognize the backup format, encryption requirements, or target workspace, contact support before restoring. Restore is not an ordinary merge or import operation.

Privacy, appearance, updates, and daily controls

Where: Top bar · Settings · Evidence · Security

Hide sensitive details when someone can see your screen

Select **Privacy on/off** at the top, or the privacy-mode card in Settings. Privacy mode masks customer and evidence details; it does not delete them. Turn it off only when you are ready to view the information privately. Select **Lock** when leaving the desk.

Choose a comfortable appearance

Open **Settings** and select a theme. Use a theme with readable contrast on your display. Some long pages require scrolling to reach the action you need.

Check for updates

Automatic checks use the Firebase update feed for the installed edition first and try a matching stable GitHub release if Firebase cannot provide a valid feed. Desktop, Cylinder Server, and Cylinder Client have separate feeds. The toolbar **Check updates** action directly checks the compatible GitHub release path when you ask it to.

An update within the same major version is incremental: it downloads in the background and installs when OverHead closes. A major-version update is identified separately; the updater can download it for in-app install-on-close, and the verified product-specific full installer is available for the regular installer wizard. Keep the app open until a background download finishes, then close it when ready.

> If update checks are unavailable, use the official site or your department distribution share. Never install a Desktop package over Cylinder or mix product update feeds.

Set reduced motion

Open **Settings** and find **Reduced motion** under accessibility preferences. The app follows your Windows motion preference by default; choose an explicit setting if you want to override it. Your choice is saved on this device.

Set reduced motion

Open **Settings** and find **Reduced motion** under accessibility preferences. The app follows your Windows motion preference by default; choose an explicit setting if you want to override it. Your choice is saved on this device.

Change operational switches deliberately

Settings contains **Operational controls**. Read a switch before changing it, change one setting at a time, and check the affected queue or sync status afterward. If you are unsure what a switch controls, leave it as it is and ask the owner.

Review activity and security information

Evidence contains integrity and activity information; **Security** contains privacy, access, and recovery controls. These screens help explain changes. An integrity indicator is not a guarantee that every account, device, or workflow is secure.

Schedule local security work

Owners can schedule a full local data export, recurring access-review tasks, local inactivity suspension, and routes from supported security events to staff inbox roles. These desktop controls run while OverHead is open and an Owner is signed in; they do not suspend Firebase-linked accounts or send push/email notices. A human must complete each access review.

Review saved sessions and merge customers

Owners can review and end other sessions saved by this local installation. The list cannot reach sessions on other devices. In Customer Management, the Duplicates tab offers an Owner-only local merge with a pre-merge backup; reconcile shared cloud records separately.

Developer source-folder and code-editor controls are for authorized maintenance. They are not needed for ordinary customer, quote, invoice, or reminder work.

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Fix common problems and get help

Where: Support · Website support center

What you see	Try this first
Only a customer support screen	Return to staff sign-in and choose OverHead Team. Customer Access opens a separate portal.
Protected or hidden records	Check Privacy on/off and reveal details only in a private setting.
An empty work queue	Clear Search current work and choose All. Check that you opened the correct workspace.
A locked feature or role error	Check Plans and Licenses. Ask the owner to review access; a saved plan selection alone does not activate it.
Sign-in or verification fails	Check the email address, use the newest verification email, and use the website's Forgot your password link if needed.
A sync error	Check the connection, read the message, and sign out/back in if shared sign-in expired. Then retry the appropriate sync.
A failed automation	Open Automations → Dead Letter, inspect the error, correct the cause, and then Retry Job.
No file after creating a PDF	Read the output path. Open that folder in File Explorer. Check for an error before pressing Create again.

Create a support ticket

1. Open **Support** → **Create support ticket**.
2. Enter **Subject**, select **Priority**, and describe the problem in **Details**.
3. Select **Create Ticket**. For shared tickets, use **Refresh queue** and check the recorded status.

If the app cannot open, use the website support center or email solidartentertainment@gmail.com.

> **Useful details:** OverHead version, Windows version, section/button used, exact error, and the last step that worked. Share a reviewed screenshot or support bundle if needed. Do not send passwords, recovery codes, card details, or unredacted customer data.

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A simple routine and quick reference

Where: Your daily checklist

At the start of the day

- Open the correct workspace and confirm your profile.
- Review Team Dashboard → Current work using Open and Blocked.
- Review appointments, open quotes, and unpaid invoices.
- Check pending approvals in Accounts and queued jobs in Automations.

After a customer call

- Find or add the customer.
- Create the needed appointment, quote, or invoice on Team Dashboard.
- Add a specific follow-up note or dated reminder.
- Attach a useful document to the correct customer when needed.

Before you close

- Confirm saved changes and mark completed work Done.
- Check customer sync if you use a shared workspace.
- Make a backup after important changes and preserve needed attachments separately.
- Record tomorrow’s first action and lock the workspace.

Word in the app	Plain meaning
Workspace	The office/business context you are signed into.
Queued / Run Due	Waiting to be processed / process jobs whose scheduled time has arrived.
Dead Letter	A job that needs attention after unsuccessful processing.
Playbook	A saved set of workflow rules for a customer.
License / entitlement	The plan and access assigned to an account.
Support bundle	A diagnostic export to review before giving it to support.

> Start with one customer and one task. You do not need to configure every optional connector before using the core office workflow.